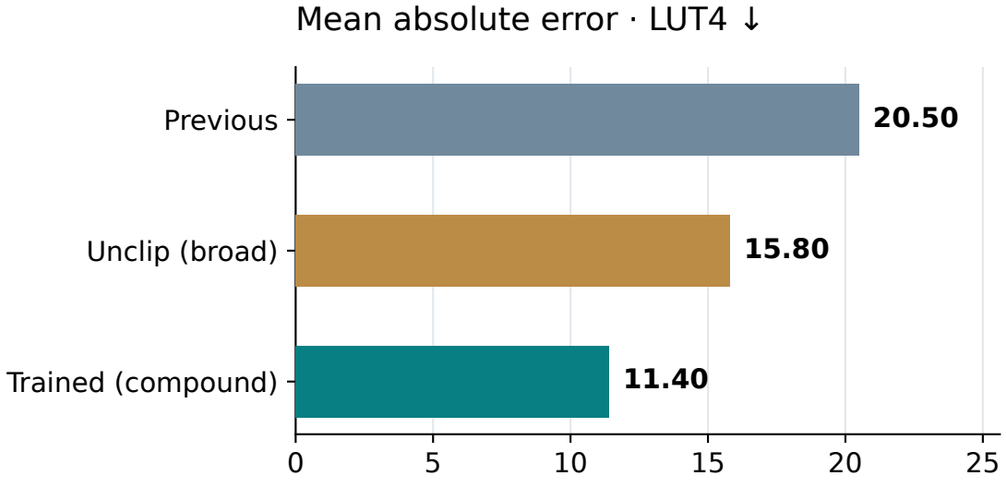
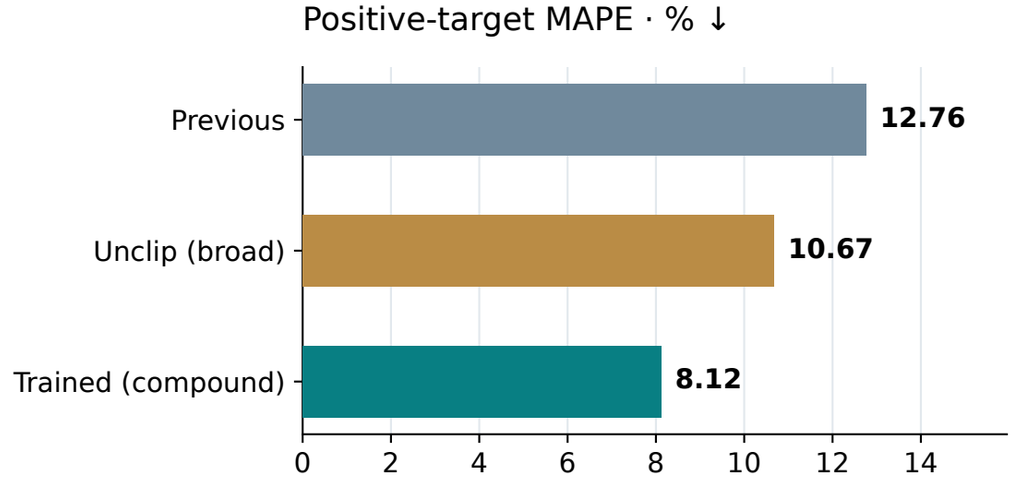
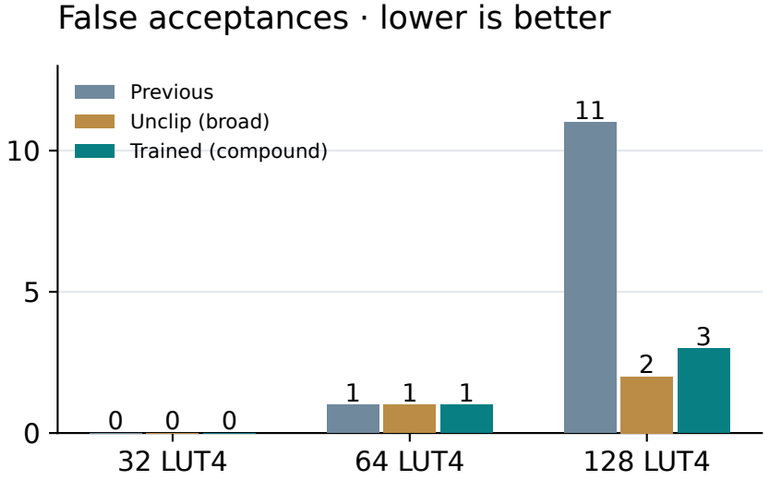
Can better area estimates reduce budget mistakes?

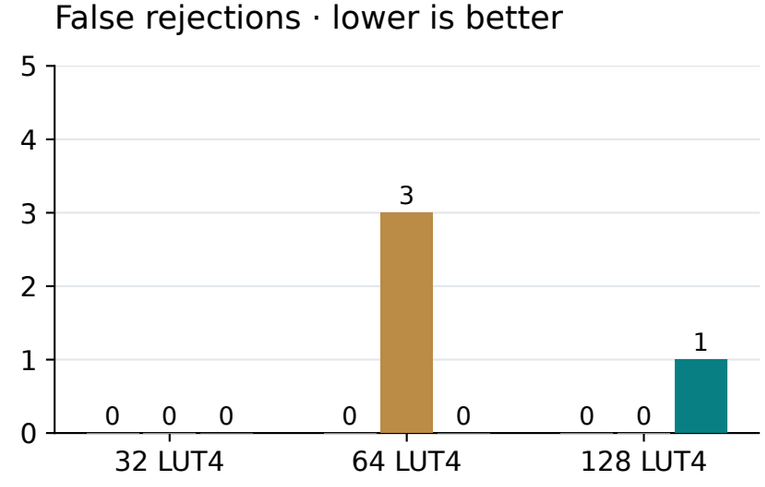
40 fresh synthetic circuits · matched labels · policies and predictions frozen before test synthesis

Predeclared selection and fresh gates: NOT PASSED — candidate remains diagnostic









32 LUT4: 0 feasible / 40 infeasible · 64 LUT4: 7 feasible / 33 infeasible · 128 LUT4: 20 feasible / 20 infeasible

Worst underprediction (previous → unclip only → new): 85.00 → 52.12 → 52.12 LUT4.

Unclip-only uses a broader route: aggregate differences do not isolate training gains. Earlier panels are consumed development evidence.

Targeted isolated iCE40 area study; no calibrated safety, application-transfer, timing, power or CPU-speed claim.